

SPANISH VERB CONJUGATIONS - SALUDAR (TO GREET / TO SAY HELLO)

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PRESENT SIMPLE: Presente

Yo **saludo** - I greet / I say hello

Tú **saludas** - You greet

Él/Ella saluda - He/She greets

Nosotros saludamos - We greet

Vosotros saludáis - You all greet (Spain)

Ellos saludan - They greet

PAST SIMPLE (Preterite): Pretérito Perfecto

Yo **saludé** - I greeted / I said hello

Tú **saludaste** - You greeted

Él/Ella saludó - He/She greeted

Nosotros saludamos - We greeted

Vosotros saludasteis - You all greeted (Spain)

Ellos saludaron - They greeted

FUTURE SIMPLE: Futuro

Yo **saludaré** - I will greet / I will say hello

Tú **saludarás** - You will greet

Él/Ella saludará - He/She will greet

Nosotros saludaremos - We will greet

Vosotros saludaréis - You all will greet (Spain)

Ellos saludarán - They will greet

PRESENT CONTINUOUS: Presente Continuo / Presente Progresivo

Yo **estoy saludando** - I am greeting / I am saying hello

Tú **estás saludando** - You are greeting

Él/Ella está saludando - He/She is greeting

Nosotros estamos saludando - We are greeting

Vosotros estáis saludando - You all are greeting (Spain)

Ellos están saludando - They are greeting

PAST CONTINUOUS: Pretérito Imperfecto Continuo

Yo **estaba saludando** - I was greeting / I was saying hello

Tú **estabas saludando** - You were greeting

Él/Ella estaba saludando - He/She was greeting

Nosotros estábamos saludando - We were greeting

Vosotros estabais saludando - You all were greeting (Spain)

Ellos estaban saludando - They were greeting

FUTURE CONTINUOUS: Futuro continuo/progresivo

Yo **estaré saludando** - I will be greeting / I will be saying hello

Tú **estarás saludando** - You will be greeting

Él/Ella estará saludando - He/She will be greeting

Nosotros estaremos saludando - We will be greeting

Vosotros estaréis saludando - You all will be greeting (Spain)

Ellos estarán saludando - They will be greeting

PRESENT PERFECT: Pretérito Perfecto Compuesto

Yo **he saludado** - I have greeted / I have said hello

Tú **has saludado** - You have greeted

Él/Ella ha saludado - He/She has greeted

Nosotros hemos saludado - We have greeted

Vosotros habéis saludado - You all have greeted (Spain)

Ellos han saludado - They have greeted

PAST PERFECT: Pretérito Pluscuamperfecto

Yo **había saludado** - I had greeted / I had said hello

Tú **habías saludado** - You had greeted

Él/Ella había saludado - He/She had greeted

Nosotros habíamos saludado - We had greeted

Vosotros habíais saludado - You all had greeted (Spain)

Ellos habían saludado - They had greeted

FUTURE PERFECT: Futuro Perfecto

Yo **habré saludado** - I will have greeted / I will have said hello

Tú **habrás saludado** - You will have greeted

Él/Ella habrá saludado - He/She will have greeted

Nosotros habremos saludado - We will have greeted

Vosotros habréis saludado - You all will have greeted (Spain)

Ellos habrán saludado - They will have greeted

CONDITIONAL:

Yo **saludaría** - I would greet / I would say hello

Tú **saludarías** - You would greet

Él/Ella **saludaría** - He/She would greet

Nosotros **saludaríamos** - We would greet

Vosotros **saludaríais** - You all would greet (Spain)

Ellos **saludarían** - They would greet

COULD GREET (PODER + INFINITIVE): CONDITIONAL

Yo **podría saludar** - I could greet / I could say hello

Tú **podrías saludar** - You could greet

Él/Ella **podría saludar** - He/She could greet

Nosotros **podríamos saludar** - We could greet

Vosotros **podríais saludar** - You all could greet (Spain)

Ellos **podrían saludar** - They could greet

SHOULD GREET (DEBER + INFINITIVE): CONDITIONAL

Yo **debería saludar** - I should greet / I should say hello

Tú **deberías saludar** - You should greet

Él/Ella **debería saludar** - He/She should greet

Nosotros **deberíamos saludar** - We should greet

Vosotros **deberíais saludar** - You all should greet (Spain)

Ellos **deberían saludar** - They should greet

EXAMPLE SENTENCES:

- Podría saludar a mis vecinos cuando los vea.

(I could greet my neighbors when I see them.)

- Debería saludar más a menudo a mis compañeros de trabajo.

(I should greet my coworkers more often.)

- Tengo que saludar a la familia de mi parte. (I have to say hello to the family from me.)

✅ **Good News About "Saludar"**:

Saludar is a **100% regular -ar verb** — no stem changes, no spelling changes, no irregularities! 🎉

◆ **Pattern to Remember**:

All regular -ar verbs follow this same conjugation pattern:

| Ending | Example: Saludar | Other -ar verbs |

|-----|-----|-----|

| -o | saludo | hablar → hablo, trabajar → trabajo |

| -as | saludas | hablar → hablas, trabajar → trabajas |

| -a | saluda | hablar → habla, trabajar → trabaja |

| -amos | saludamos | hablar → hablamos, trabajar → trabajamos |

| -áis | saludáis | hablar → habláis, trabajar → trabajáis |

| -an | saludan | hablar → hablan, trabajar → trabajan |

📌 **Important Usage Notes: "Saludar" + Personal "A"**:

When *saludar* is followed by a specific person, Spanish requires the **personal "a"**:

| Structure | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *saludar **a** + person* | to greet someone | *Saludo **a** María.* (I greet María.) |

| *saludar **de parte de** + person* | to say hello from someone | *Te saludo **de parte de** Juan.* |

| *mandar saludos **a** + person* | to send greetings to someone | *Manda saludos **a** tu familia.* |

💡 **Key Tip:** Never omit the personal **a** when greeting a specific person!

- ✅ *Saludo **a** mi jefe.*

- ❌ ~~Saludo mi jefe.~~

📖 **Common Phrases with "Saludar":**

| Phrase | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *saludar con la mano* | to wave hello | *Le saludé con la mano desde lejos.* |

| *saludar con un beso/abrazo* | to greet with a kiss/hug | *En España, se saluda con dos besos.* |

| *saludar cordialmente* | to greet warmly | *Nos saludaron muy cordialmente.* |

| *sin saludar* | without saying hello | *Se fue sin saludar.* |

| *¡Saluda a... de mi parte!* | Say hello to... for me! | *¡Saluda a tus padres de mi parte!* |

| *mandar/recibir saludos* | to send/receive greetings | *Te mando saludos desde México.* |

📖 **Cultural Note: Greeting Customs in Spanish-Speaking Countries:**

| Country/Region | Typical Greeting |

|-----|-----|

| **Spain** | Two kisses (cheek to cheek) among friends/family |

| **Mexico** | Handshake or one kiss; hug among close friends |

| **Argentina** | One kiss on the right cheek |

| **Colombia** | Handshake or kiss depending on region |

| **Business contexts** | Handshake is standard everywhere |

💡 **Pro Tip** — "Saludar" vs. "Decir hola":

| Expression | Meaning | Usage |

|-----|-----|-----|

| **Saludar** | to greet (verb) | More formal, complete action |

| **Decir hola** | to say hello | More casual, literal |

- **Voy a saludar** a los invitados. (I'm going to greet the guests.)

- **Voy a decir hola** a los invitados. (I'm going to say hi to the guests.)

Both are correct — **saludar** sounds slightly more polished!

🔄 **Other Common Regular -ar Verbs:**

- **hablar** (to speak)

- **trabajar** (to work)

- **estudiar** (to study)

- **usar** (to use)

- **viajar** (to travel)

- **comprar** (to buy)

- **bailar** (to dance)

💡 ****Pro Tip — Polite Greetings in Spanish****:

| Situation | Phrase | Translation |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Meeting someone | *Mucho gusto.* | Nice to meet you. |

| Seeing someone again | *¡Qué gusto verte!* | So good to see you! |

| Formal greeting | *Es un placer saludarle.* | It's a pleasure to greet you. |

| Leaving | *Que tenga un buen día.* | Have a good day. |

| Sending regards | *Dale saludos de mi parte.* | Give them my regards. |

✅ ****Ready for the next verb!**** Just say: ****"Next verb: [verb]"**** 🚀